

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

ARKANSAS TEACHER CORPS

ALTERNATIVE ROUTE

On-Site Review: September 18-19, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

ARKANSAS TEACHER CORPS

ALTERNATIVE ROUTE

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
APPROACHING	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	EXCEEDS	BELOW
Recommendations		
Arkansas Teacher Corps is far exceeding the state's target for recruiting candidates and demonstrates commitment to enrollment into certification shortage areas. However, the EPP is not meeting targets for the percentage of candidates who successfully complete the program within three years, likely due to the longer-than-usual length of the program. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 1.3a).</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	Arkansas Teacher Corps' Annual Plan addressed all indicators of the state framework and indicated evidence of considerable candidate support with a focus on the "grow your own" model.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

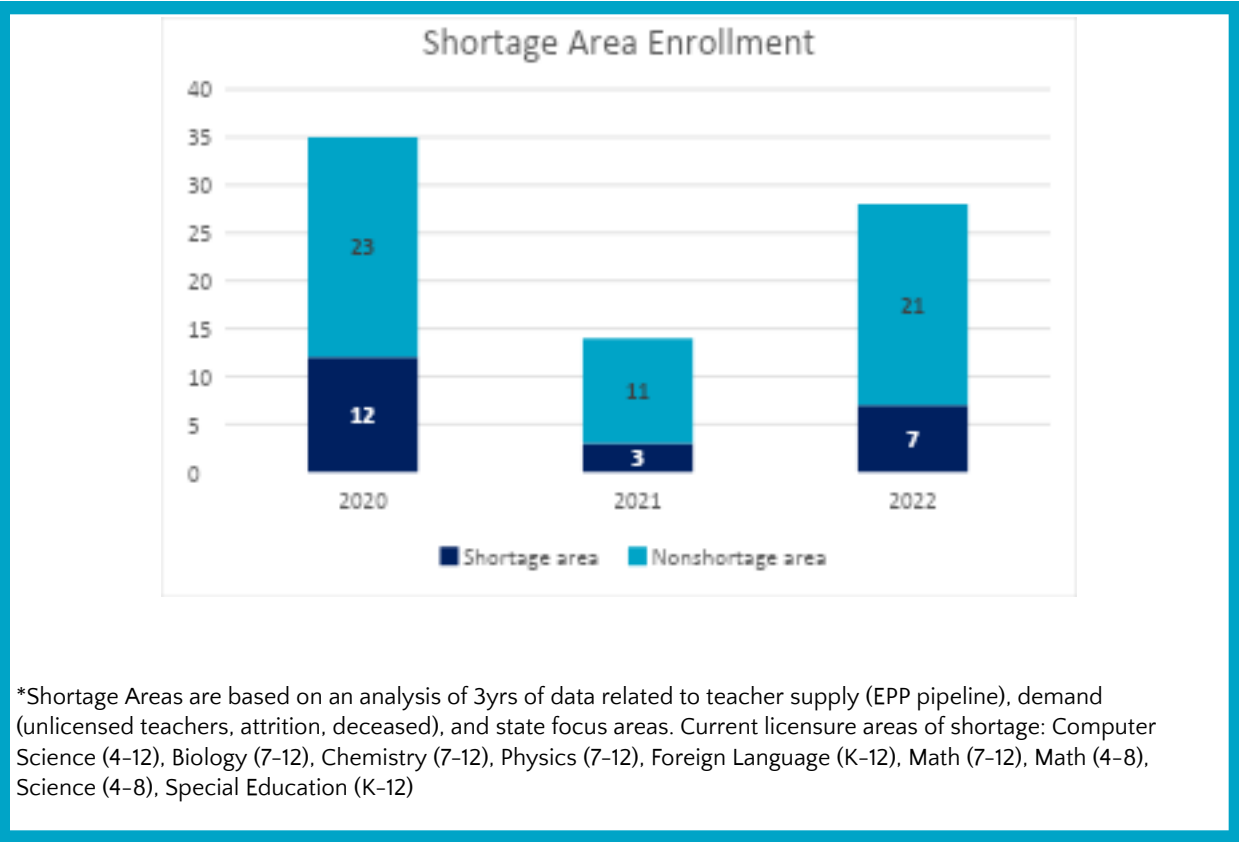
Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	60%	EXCEEDS

Metric is the percentage growth between the blue and green boxes.

Year	Percentage Growth
2017	27
2018	21
2019	2
2020	35
2021	14
2022	28

*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	29%	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	74%	60%	BELOW



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	APPROACHING	MEETS
Recommendations		
Arkansas Teacher Corps effectively prepares its teacher candidates (Fellows) to be teachers in Arkansas by purposefully and explicitly referencing Arkansas-specific Academic and Teaching standards, access to trainings such as ArkansasIDEAS, state-approved HQIM and preparing both faculty and candidates to assess classroom instruction using the Aspiring Teacher Rubric and TESS. ATC sequences its coursework and clinical experiences to maximize the impact of Summer Institute so that candidates are better prepared to serve students during the three-year clinical internship. As a result, most candidates achieve program milestones in coursework and clinical experience. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - While references to Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards are included in course materials, ATC should ensure that all course instructors are trained to incorporate them into the delivery of the coursework and that candidates are proficient in them. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 2.1b Metric 2, Criteria 2.1c Metric 1)</i> - Formalize and standardize communication channels with all districts/schools where participants teach to ensure two-way communication around candidate needs, experiences, and effectiveness during the three-year internship. In addition to coaching by ATC's clinical supervisor, an effective partnership between the district/school mentors and ATC will be important for the teacher candidate experience. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 2.2b Metric 2, Criteria 2.2c Metric 1)</i> - Begin preparing now to meet the state's one-year residency requirement that will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond. Formalize systems and structures to ensure that the mentor teachers and clinical supervisors working with candidates in the building are experienced, very effective and, by the 2026-2027 school year, have received DESE-recognized coaching training. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 2.2b, 2.3c Metric 2)</i>		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction
MEETS
Although the rules of licensure for alternative route programs do not specify guidance for coursework, Arkansas Teacher Corps prepares its teacher candidates (Fellows) with course sessions that incorporate and demonstrate best

practices around content instruction to prepare them to be Day One ready. For example, during Summer Institute, specific sessions focus on learning outcomes, lesson plans with feedback and opportunities for revision, assessments, rubrics, and discussion. Before Year 1, coursework includes ArkansasIDEAS professional development, and during years one to three, teaching candidates (Fellows) receive LETRS training. During Summer Institute there is time structured into the schedule to introduce HQIM, analyze the components and familiarize teacher candidates (Fellows) with DESE guidance and EdReports, and time to apply techniques such as TESS-aligned Questioning and Discussion Techniques (3b) to improve engagement and understanding. Referenced HQIM include Illustrative Mathematics, My Perspectives, and OpenSciEd.

During the coursework observations, reviewers noted instances of instructors including HQIM and best practices around content instruction. For example, the instructors for the “HQIM and Unit Planning” session focused instruction on the exploration of the DESE-approved HQIM materials. Candidates explored different components of the HQIMs. In the “Tier 2 Interventions” course observation, the reviewers noted “the workshop session provided best practice instruction and focused on positive behavior intervention systems to utilize in a school and in a classroom. The course instructors engaged the teaching candidates in discussion about student needs, issues related to behaviors in the classroom, and support systems that could be utilized for the classroom. A tiered level of support system is a best practice that is recognized for behavior support.” In the Coursework focus group, participating Fellows mentioned receiving training, support, and resources for classroom instruction. All teacher candidates (Fellows) responded they felt confident in their skills to support reading in their classroom. In the Course Instructor focus group, participating Instructors shared that the coursework also incorporates “Transformational Teacher” philosophy and strategies.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards. During Summer Institute there are sessions specifically focused on learning about standards and objectives. The session teaches teacher candidates (Fellows) how to unpack standards and use Bloom’s taxonomy to write lesson objectives. Teacher candidates (Fellows) become familiar with the DESE website that lists AR K-12 standards. The evidence provided included specific examples of teacher candidates (Fellows’) written lesson plans that include assessments that are aligned with the standards. Coursework clearly and intentionally provides candidates opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. The evidence provided an example from Summer Institute that defines vertical alignment and offers opportunities for group work to discuss standards for specific subjects and grade levels above and below the assigned grade.

In the Coursework focus group, all participants shared that they created lesson plans connected with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards during Summer Institute. They shared examples of role playing in small groups and providing instruction, and they were required to vertically align instruction in their classroom. The “Standards and Objectives” session during Summer Institute clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally sequenced to build from the basics of instruction and the classroom to more rigorous topics and strategies. The unit lesson plan builds throughout the six (6) week Summer Institute to show the growth and knowledge of the teacher candidates (Fellows) over time. The “ATC Summer Institute 2024 Calendar” illustrates how courses are “intentionally sequenced.... allowing for cycles of learning a new skill/strategy and trying it in practice.” For example, the courses “Standards and Objectives,” “Measuring Learning-Exit Tickets,” and “Questioning and Engagement Strategies” come before “Unit Planning,” and “Feedback and Grading,” allowing strong foundational knowledge to be built first. During the school year, Saturday sessions are guided to support them as the teacher candidates (Fellows) progress in student learning, needs, and support.

Reinforcement opportunities for candidate areas of growth and a progressive increase in rigor can be seen in the ATC TESS Focus Areas: “Instructional coursework during the school year is guided by a focus on high-leverage areas of the Aspiring Teacher Rubric that have been intentionally sequenced over the three-year teacher candidates (Fellows)hip...these are the competencies that best align with [the Teacher candidates (Fellows)] clinical experiences and that can reasonably be mastered at that point of their experience.” Each domain spans across Summer Institute and the first three years in the classroom. All metrics are covered explicitly at least two times. Some are introduced

and covered every year, for example, “Reflecting on Teaching” and “Growing and Developing Professionally.” In the Course Instructor focus group, participants shared that coursework is intentionally sequenced to build from the basics of instruction and the classroom to more rigorous topics and strategies. The unit lesson plan is built throughout the six-week Summer Institute to show the growth and knowledge of the teacher candidates (Fellows) over time. During the school year, Saturday sessions are guided to support them as the teacher candidates (Fellows) progress in student learning, needs, and support.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

APPROACHING

The “ATC Fellow Handbook” and “Summer Institute 2024 Syllabus” list the Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards under the section of “Foundations of Fellow Development.” The “Summer Institute Calendar” indicates which sessions incorporate the ATS. The “ATC TESS Aspiring Teacher Rubric” charts which Aspiring TESS focus areas are targeted, and in which years. In the Content Instructor focus group participants explained that courses are designed around the Arkansas Educator Competencies and the guidelines provided by ADE DESE.

The evidence provided includes the matrix but does not include examples of where and how the Arkansas Teaching Standards are incorporated in the coursework. Reviewers did not observe evidence of the Arkansas Teaching Standards in their observations. In the Coursework focus group, teacher candidates were asked about their knowledge of the Arkansas Teaching Standards and InTASC; however, no one was familiar with the terminology and able to answer those questions.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience. Examples are provided in the “Overview Session” and “Institute Outcomes” chart where teaching skills are mapped out by week of the clinical experience, and individual check ins revolve around the goals for that week. Candidates check in one-to-one with their coach, and they make a presentation about their growth at the end of the program.

In the “Unit Planning and HQIM” observation, reviewers noted, “Classroom lessons/unit plans were linked to the HQIM materials that each district would utilize. The instructors said that each district might have adopted different HQIMs, so the candidates would be exploring all of the different HQIMs during this time together. Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. The instructor put the [Teacher candidates (Fellows)] in small groups/break out rooms to discuss and came back together as a whole group for reflection and debriefs.” Reviewers noted similar instances in other observations. In the Coursework focus group, participants shared examples of how they have connected their Summer Institute assignments and discussions to what they use in their classroom on a daily basis. They gave examples such as the lesson planning, engagement strategies, and the instructional resources provided by ATC. In the Course Instructor focus group, the participants explained that the Teacher candidates (Fellows) are all teachers of record, and the coursework and support system is intentionally designed to support what the Teacher candidates (Fellows) will be expected to do in their classrooms and districts.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

APPROACHING

Some course instructors show deep knowledge of the Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards, content knowledge and content pedagogy. ATC listed nine course instructors. All nine have degrees and are certified, and eight have three or more years of teaching experience. Over 80% have professional development including Cognitive Coaching; however, only two of the nine have TESS rubric training, and only one instructor has had professional development in a HQIM (Open SciEd). In observations, reviewers noted that course instructors’ references to Arkansas K-12 Curriculum standards were not always clear. During the Coursework Instructor focus group, although all participants discussed best practices in instructional strategies and content areas, only two of the six participants discussed having experience using or having training in HQIM materials. In the “Interview Guide” submitted, although some questions

that are asked of potential candidates revolve around professionalism and experience, there were no questions submitted that inquire about curriculum knowledge or training.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors have a proven history and show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. ATC provides facilitation development for their course instructors. The onboarding and training for the facilitators was outlined in the evidence provided. It includes topics such as “Facilitate Adaptively” and “Adult Learning.”

The “ATC Summer Institute 2024 Survey Data” is compiled from the weekly surveys that the forty-five Teacher candidates (Fellows) take throughout Summer Institute. Some questions evaluate their course instructors on their facilitation: for example, “the facilitation of the instructional skills sessions was clear and helped me engage in learning”. This survey item received a 4.64 out of 5. Five is the highest and all ratings regarding facilitation were above 80%. Evidence also shows that Teacher candidates (Fellows) feel supported. Survey responses regarding the support Teacher candidates (Fellows) have received from ATC are consistently above 80%. In one of the course observations, reviewers noted, the course instructor provided Teacher candidates (Fellows) with support such as guiding questions, discussions and links to additional instructional resources.

Other course instructors utilized book studies, mentoring sessions, and strategies from EdWell to support teacher candidates (Fellows) to manage and balance the demands of the profession.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The sequence of clinical experiences clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. Teacher candidates complete a six-week Summer Institute prior to their first year in the program. Throughout the 6-week Summer Institute, teacher candidates practice lesson planning and delivering instruction in front of their peers while completing the feedback cycle on each component. In weeks 2-6, teacher candidates submit lesson plans for review, revise based on feedback and re-deliver the lesson, followed by another feedback cycle. This continues into the school year when teacher candidates begin teaching as the teacher of record at their school and continue their residency. Teacher candidates are observed by the EPP twice per week in quarter one, once per week in quarter two and then twice per month through year three.

Additionally, Summer Institute incorporates TESS Focus Areas, and these focus areas continue to be layered into years one through three of a Fellow’s enrollment at ATC. Finally, as evidenced in the “Summer Institute Look Fors” document, the observation criteria continue to build in rigor each week. After facilitating the Course Instructor focus group, the reviewers wrote, “The EPP meets expectations for having a sequence of clinical experiences, despite not following a traditional model. The program demonstrates an intentional build-up of experiences and expectations throughout the three-year teacher candidate’s internship. The sequence begins with Summer Institute where teacher candidates (TCs) receive foundational skills training and engage in peer-to-peer teaching. This initial experience allows TCs to practice lesson planning, goal setting, and data-driven decision-making in a supportive environment before entering their own classrooms. Following Summer Institute, TCs are assigned to cohorts with dedicated coaches who provide ongoing, one-on-one support tailored to each TC’s needs.”

As teacher candidates (Fellows) progress through the program, expectations and accountability increase. For example, the program has established benchmarks on the TESS evaluation, expecting teachers to demonstrate increased proficiency across their three years as teacher of record with the EPP. If teacher candidates (Fellows) do not meet these benchmarks, they are placed on professional improvement plans, ensuring continuous growth and support.

The program also incorporates a variety of clinical experiences throughout the three years. Teacher candidates engage in peer observations, receive modeling from coaches (including co-teaching opportunities), and have access to a library of exemplary teaching videos.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences
MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. Teacher candidates in the ATC program are placed as Teachers of Record in school settings across Arkansas, naturally exposing them to a wide range of student needs. This placement strategy ensures that teacher candidates gain experience working with diverse learners in authentic classroom environments throughout their three-years in the EPP.

The EPP faculty described the program's emphasis on supporting students with special needs. Teacher candidates receive professional development on working with students who have IEPs and 504 plans. They are actively involved in these processes, attending meetings and learning how to implement accommodations and modifications in their classrooms. This hands-on experience provides teacher candidates with valuable insights into supporting students with diverse learning needs.

Teacher candidates also support English Learners (ELs) in their teaching placements. One coach mentioned that some teacher candidates are placed in districts with high populations of ELLs, with one specific district having over 70% ELL students. This placement ensures that teacher candidates gain significant experience in adapting instruction for language learners and using appropriate strategies to support their academic growth.

The program also provides professional development on using multiple modalities (i.e., visual, auditory, kinesthetic) in instruction, equipping TCs with strategies to address various learning needs in their classrooms. Coaches also work closely with TCs to analyze student data and develop targeted interventions for different groups of students, further enhancing their ability to meet diverse learning needs. These examples demonstrate that the ATC program provides a variety of clinical experiences that prepare teacher candidates to be effective in diverse classroom settings.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship
APPROACHING

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers
APPROACHING

Some experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. During Summer Institute, ATC hires a team of Mentor Teachers to support Teacher candidates (Fellows) through the 6-week summer program. Mentors attend 7 development sessions prior to Summer Institute and attend 6 meetings during Summer Institute to reflect on their role, hear feedback, and collaborate. However, whereas 8 out of 9 mentors have more than 3 years of teaching experience, only 3 of the 9 mentors are trained on the TESS or Aspiring Teacher Rubric and only 1 has completed a [state recognized training program](#).

During years one through three while Teacher candidates (Fellows) are teachers of record, ATC does not oversee the experienced mentor teacher component of a teacher candidate's internship experience. ATC asks all partner schools to assign a mentor teacher to each teacher candidate, and in their MOU it says, "to the extent possible, provide highly effective coach or mentor teacher." In the Clinical Internship focus group, 2 of the 4 participants did not have a mentor teacher assigned to them. The two participants who did have a mentor teacher had a positive experience and valued their mentor teacher's partnership.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers
APPROACHING

A partial process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers based on a set of criteria. During the EPP Partner focus group, all four participants agreed that they follow the LEARNS Act criteria to select experienced mentor

teachers for their ATC teacher candidates. However, one participant shared that it is very hard to find teachers in their district who meet the criteria, so not all mentor teachers meet the selection requirements. As mentioned previously, not all teacher candidates have a mentor teacher assigned to them by their school, indicating that not all partner schools or districts select mentor teachers for their ATC teacher candidates.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors have a proven history and show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. ATC employs a team of 7 coaches, all who hold AR teaching licenses and have at least 3 years of teaching experience and have completed a state-recognized coaching training program.

The “Data for Continuous Improvement” document indicates team wide goals are set yearly based on previous year’s data. Additionally, coaches set goals based on the “Transformational Coaching Rubric.” Coaches receive feedback regularly and are evaluated regularly. In the “Culture Survey,” all respondents indicated they agree or strongly agree with the statements “I believe that my coach is knowledgeable and skilled in teaching theory and practices” and “I am satisfied with the quality and frequency of coaching I receive through ATC.”

Finally, the ATC team clearly reflects on their work, as evidenced in the “March Full-Team Meeting” deck and the evaluation sample shared as evidence. This indicates ATC is working towards continuous improvement; however, no evidence was shared to highlight what next steps or program improvements were made because of their data and reflection.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high quality feedback from their clinical supervisor that is frequent, oral and written, connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, clearly linked to evidence of student learning during observed lesson and builds on previous feedback. During a coaching observation, one reviewer noted “the quality of feedback provided to the teacher candidate was balanced, supportive, and thoughtful. The clinical supervisor began with an SEL (social emotional learning) check-in, creating a comfortable atmosphere before diving into the more technical aspects of the feedback. The feedback was highly reflective, as the clinical supervisor consistently asked open-ended questions, such as “What do you feel is going well?” and “What would you change if you taught this lesson again?”

Teacher candidates check in one-on-one with their mentors during Summer Institute and utilize an “Observation and Debrief Template” to track their conversations and assess progress or identify any areas of growth. In addition to receiving feedback from their mentor, teacher candidates also give feedback to and receive feedback from their peers. Throughout the school year, teacher candidates upload videos of their lessons and receive virtual feedback. This feedback can be connected to specific competencies on the TESS rubric. Teacher candidates (Fellows) are also formally evaluated on TESS once per semester. As part of this evaluation, Teacher candidates (Fellows) complete a self-reflection and receive written feedback to track their progress each semester.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools APPROACHING

Collaborative processes are in place with some districts and schools to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. ATC has very positive relationships with their partner schools and districts. In the EPP Partnership focus group, all four participants agreed that ATC is easy to work with and produces high quality teacher candidates. They all shared examples of how they have collaborated to support teachers in their buildings, and in one email shared as evidence, the ATC clinical supervisor and the school principal were working together to support a struggling teacher – both sharing resources and their individual next steps.

While there is evidence of communication and collaboration, it appears largely informal and reactive rather than systematically planned. For example, a participant in the EPP Partnership focus group noted that most communication occurs by phone or email, with no formal meetings. This ad hoc approach, while functional, may miss opportunities for deeper, more strategic collaboration. ATC submitted evidence from an “External Stakeholder Survey” from 2019.

The feedback in the survey is mostly positive; however, COVID disrupted some of the formal processes that were previously in place, including the survey and an Advisory Board that included partner schools.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are consistently in place that support and develop effective clinical supervisors. The “ATC Coach Development Overview” clearly outlines the vision ATC has for coach development based on the Transformational Coaching Rubric. Coaches engage in beginning of the year conversations with their manager and set goals for the year. They continue to check-in weekly on their progress towards goals. Each clinical supervisor works directly with their manager to reflect on their performance, identify areas of strength, and set goals for continued growth.

Clinical supervisors participate in regular Professional Learning Communities (PLCs). They discuss current issues, share best practices, and engage in collaborative problem-solving. Additionally, they participate in book studies, allowing for deeper exploration of relevant educational topics and strategies.

Another strong example is the program's investment in specialized training. All clinical supervisors are scheduled to undergo cognitive coaching training, with new coaches attending an intensive week-long session. Furthermore, coaches are encouraged to attend state-level sessions on topics such as the Aspiring Teacher Excellence and Support System (TESS) and High-Quality Instructional Materials (HQIM), demonstrating a commitment to staying current with state educational initiatives. The program has implemented a comprehensive system for coaches' ongoing professional development and growth, ensuring they can effectively support teacher candidates.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

APPROACHING

Some candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. During Summer Institute, ATC tracks candidate mastery of required skills and around 80% of teacher candidates mastered the evaluated skills. During the school year, teacher candidates are expected to complete 40 hours of professional development. PD hours are also tracked and most appeared to be on track to meeting the requirement.

However, without school year coursework and skills-based tracking, it is unclear if teacher candidates are learning the knowledge and pedagogy to determine their proficiency.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track, and they take an active role in creating the plan and monitoring progress. When a teacher candidate falls behind (i.e., struggling with completion, missed too many hours, not mastering evaluated skills, etc.), they are placed on a support plan. The support plan lays out the steps the teacher candidate must take to get back on track, follow up notes, and deadlines. Evidence shows that 93.5% of teacher candidates who are on a support plan successfully complete the support plan.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internship, and most candidates meet these goals and milestones. ATC provided the “ATC Fellow Milestones” chart that outlines milestones for Summer Institute and for each year of the program. Milestones are separated by coursework, coaching, teaching

and literature. TESS data shows that cohorts improve significantly from their first year in the program to their graduating year.

In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, participants shared that each clinical supervisor maintains a tracker for their TCs, documenting individual goals, progress towards them, and evidence of growth. This allows for targeted support and ensures that each TC's development is closely monitored and supported.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, one participant shared they work with teacher candidates to analyze student performance data, including standardized test results and classroom assessments. During extended debriefs, coaches and teacher candidates examine this data to identify trends, discuss strategies for meeting students "where they are at," and plan interventions to have the greatest impact on student learning. Another participant shared information about the ATC's emphasis on setting and tracking student growth goals. In some districts, teacher candidates are assessed quarterly on their ability to increase student growth. Clinical supervisors collaborate with teacher candidates to establish these goals and develop strategies to support students in meeting them. This approach ensures that teacher candidates are consistently focused on their impact on student learning.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive a score of "effective" on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (or TESS rubric before 2024) at the end of their internship. There is adequate evidence to suggest that cohorts make significant progress each semester they are evaluated. For example, the 2024 cohort received an average rating of 2.27 when they entered the program in 2021, and they ended the program with an average rating of 3.1. The 2023 cohort completed with an average TESS rating of 3.17, the 2022 cohort completed with an average of 2.94 TESS rating and the 2021 cohort completed with an average TESS rating of 3.15.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

All candidates with varied needs are provided with the support they need; and most high performing candidates receive opportunities and feedback that encourage retention. ATC tracks and monitors progress for each of their teacher candidates, and if someone is not meeting program requirements, they are placed on a support plan that includes clear next steps and expectations. In one observation, the reviewer noted, "when the teacher candidate expressed feeling overwhelmed and struggling with classroom management, the clinical supervisor crafted a tailored support plan. This plan included strategies for mindfulness, regular check-ins, and targeted observations of challenging classes. The supervisors' willingness to provide this level of customized support demonstrates their commitment to ensuring each candidate's success."

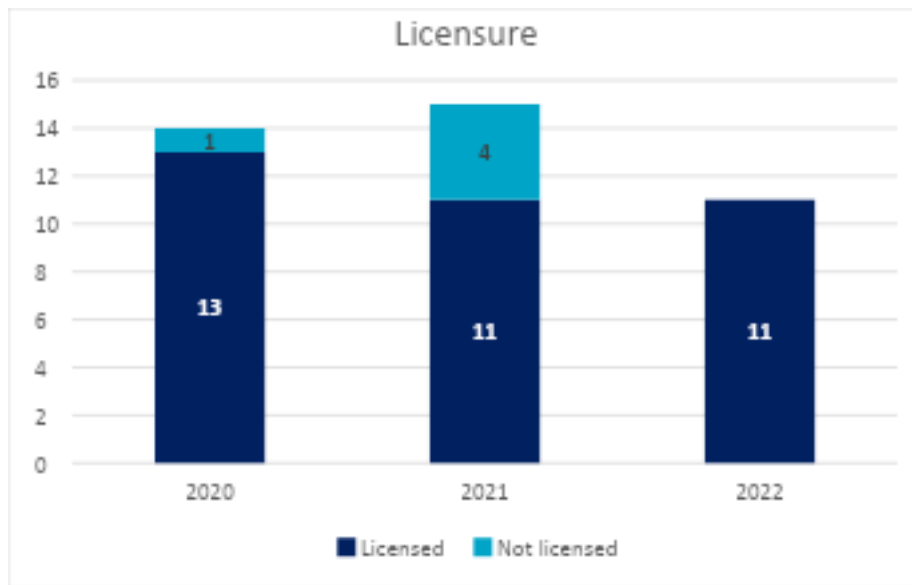
In addition to support for struggling teacher candidates, high performers are often given leadership opportunities within the program, such as leading sessions at regional workshops or mentoring peers. For instance, one coach described how a teacher who excelled in science content but struggled with classroom management was asked to lead a content session for peers, boosting their confidence and engagement in the program. In the Clinical Experience focus group, one of the alumni of the program shared that she's been asked to lead PD sessions during the Saturday sessions.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
MEETS	EXCEEDS	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
Arkansas Teacher Corps produces teachers who work in Arkansas public schools, who serve in high-priority schools, and who stay for more than three years after program completion. According to the EPP Completer Survey candidates meet state targets for satisfaction with how well the program prepared them to be a teacher. Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that ATC program candidates are prepared to obtain provisional licensure when seeking employment while enrolled. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1b</i>) - Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey results to identify specific domains and components for which supervisors do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher, and the value-added data for completers suggests that Arkansas Teacher Corps teachers' impact on student growth could be improved. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a and 3.3c</i>)		

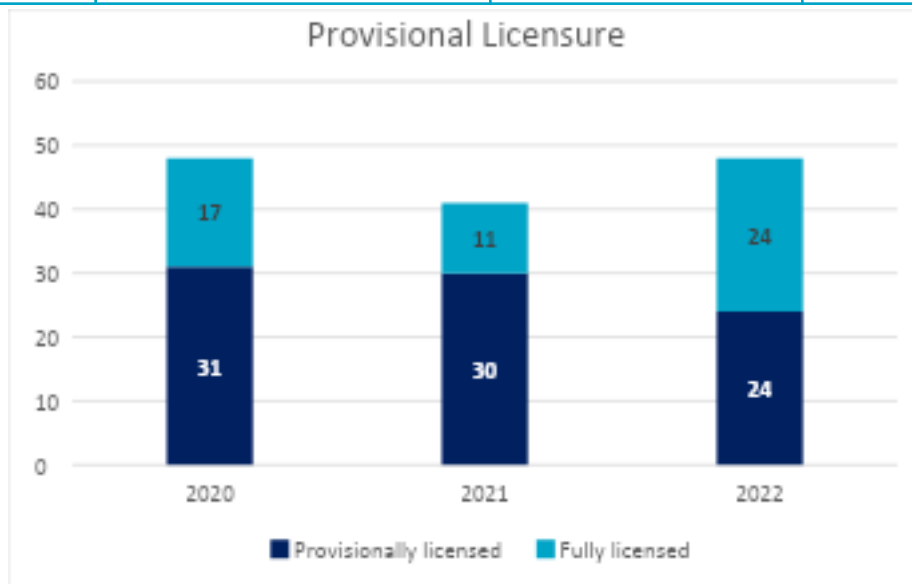
INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license	76%	88%	EXCEEDS



Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	62%	APPROACHING



Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level

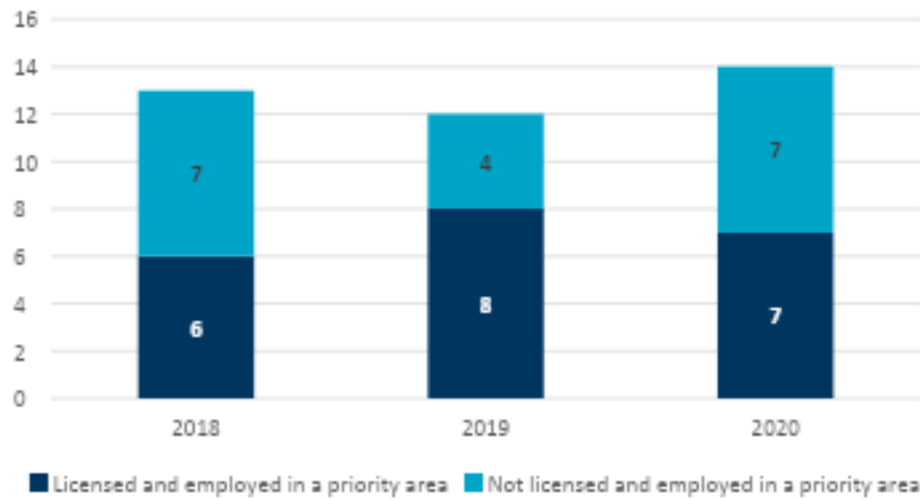
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	n/a	n/a

INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	69%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and employed</th><th>Not licensed and employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2018</td><td>9</td><td>4</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>9</td><td>3</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>9</td><td>5</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed	2018	9	4	2019	9	3	2020	9	5
Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed													
2018	9	4													
2019	9	3													
2020	9	5													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public	40%	54%	EXCEEDS												

school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion

Priority Employment



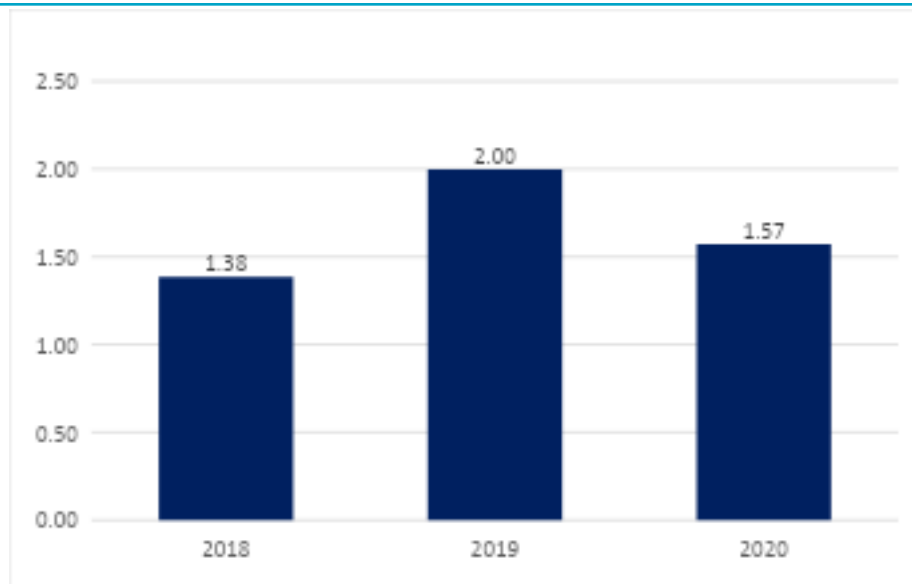
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.64	MEETS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	81%	66.7%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	75%	100%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	38%	APPROACHING

Value-Added Growth Scores

